

Syllabus

Course Title and Code: Fundamentals of Professional Communication (CC1110)	
Teaching Scheme and no. of hours per week	L-T-P: 3-0-0 (3 hours)
Credits	3
Programme(s) and Batch	BBA, BTech, B.Des- 2026 Batch
Semester (as per curriculum structure)	I Sem
NCrF Level (4.5/5.0/5.5/6.0)	4.5
Pre-requisite course (Course Code and Title)	Nil
Desired prior knowledge/skills	Basic Communication Skills
Weightage	Theory 30%; Practical 40%
The occupational path it may lead to, if any	Communication Specialist, Editor, AI Trainer, AI Editor, Data Annotator, Public Speaker, Team Lead
Course Objective: The objective of this course is to introduce foundational principles and practices of professional communication across academic, workplace, and interpersonal contexts. It examines communication as a structured, strategic, and relational process shaped by medium, audience, culture, and technology. Students will develop competencies in verbal, non-verbal, written, and intercultural communication while understanding the consequences of ineffective communication in professional settings. The course also addresses emerging challenges posed by artificial intelligence and globalized communication environments. Through practical exercises, case studies, and simulations, students will learn to communicate clearly, adaptively, and effectively across diverse contexts.	
Learning Outcomes: On successful completion of this course, the students should be able to: CO1: Demonstrate formal and interpersonal communication skills across professional contexts. CO2: Deliver effective oral presentations using appropriate verbal, paralinguistic, and non-verbal strategies. CO3: Adapt to cultural differences and apply communication skills appropriately across different audiences, purposes, and contexts. CO4: Recognise the impact of AI on communication practices.	

UNIT I: Foundations of Communication

- Models of communication:
 - o Linear
 - o Interactive
 - o Transactional
- Formal vs informal communication
- Barriers to effective communication (activity- based lectures)

UNIT II: Reading and listening for effective communication (activity-based lectures)

- Reading comprehension and analytical reading
- Verbal ability and language refinement
- Interpersonal communication:
 - Active listening
 - Feedback
- Empathy

UNIT III: Intercultural Communication

- Cultural frameworks: (activity-based lectures)
 - Cross-cultural nature of Communication
 - Intercultural communication
- Barriers: (activity-based lectures)
 - Language
 - Stereotypes
 - Ethnocentrism
 - Non-verbal misinterpretation
- Cultural Intelligence (CQ):
 - Awareness
 - Knowledge
 - Adaptability

UNIT IV: Oral Communication and Presentation Skills

- Kinesics: body language
- Paralinguistics: voice, tone, pace
- Structuring presentations
- Audience engagement and persuasion
- Managing anxiety and handling Q&A

Note: This entire unit is based on project-based learning.

UNIT V: Communication and AI

- Professional writing: emails, reports, proposals
- AI and communication:
 - impact on writing and communication practices
 - ethical and practical considerations
- Adapting communication across audiences

Text/Reference Books

Adler, Ronald B., and Jeanne Marquardt Elmhurst. 2009. *Communicating at Work: Principles and Practices for Business and the Professions*. 10th ed. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Bailey, Edward P. 2011. *Plain English at Work: A Guide to Writing and Speaking*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Beam, B. (2025, April 2). *The Social Price of AI Communication* | IE Insights. <https://www.ie.edu/insights/articles/the-social-price-of-ai-communication/>

Boyd, R. L., & Markowitz, D. M. (2026). Artificial Intelligence and the Psychology of Human Connection. *Perspectives on psychological science : a journal of the Association for Psychological Science*, 21(2), 192–220. <https://doi.org/10.1177/17456916251404394>

- Duarte, Nancy. 2012. *HBR Guide to Persuasive Presentations*. Boston: Harvard Business Review Press.
- Grabe, William, and Fredricka L. Stoller. 2020. *Teaching and Researching Reading*. 3rd ed. London: Routledge.
- Hall, Edward T. 1976. *Beyond Culture*. New York: Anchor Books.
- Hofstede, Geert. 2001. *Culture's Consequences: Comparing Values, Behaviors, Institutions and Organizations Across Nations*. 2nd ed. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE Publications.
- Kropp, E. (2025, September 10). The Impact of AI on Global Strategic Communication. *UF CJC Online Master's*. <https://onlinemasters.jou.ufl.edu/artificial-intelligence-in-communication/>
- Lucas, Stephen E. 2020. *The Art of Public Speaking*. 13th ed. New York: McGraw-Hill Education.

Online Resources (Please provide link)

MOOC course:

“Improving Communication Skills”; Instructor: Maurice Schweitzer,
<https://www.coursera.org/learn/wharton-communication-skills#modules>

“Effective Communication: Writing, Design, and Presentation Specialization”; Instructors: David Underwood, Quintin McAndrew, William Kuskin, <https://www.coursera.org/specializations/effective-business-communication>

Evaluation Scheme

Sr. No	Specifications	Weightage	Marks
1	Class Participation	30	30
2	Assignment	40	40
3	Quiz	Nil	Nil
4	Mid-Term Examination (Theory)	Nil	Nil
5	End-Term Examination (Theory)	30	30
6	Report	Nil	Nil
7	Project	Nil	Nil
8	Lab Evaluation	Nil	Nil
9	Course Portfolio	Nil	Nil
10	Presentation	Nil	Nil
11	Viva	Nil	Nil
	Total	100	100

Assignments (40):

- Debate/Group Discussion - 10m
- Presentation and Report [Case Studies and Analytical Reports (Barriers)]- 20m
- Journal on Communication Style (Self-Reflection)- 10m

Class Participation (30):

- Engagement in Class activities- 10 m (Individual Participation Assessment)
- Listening Comprehension- 10m
- Role Play- 10m

Attendance Policy

Every student is expected to put in 100% attendance. However, the student with attendance below 75% in a course, shall be penalized as follows.

- 70.0% to less than 75.0% attendance: A warning letter will be issued.
- 50.0% to less than 70.0% attendance: One grade drop. However, a D grade will remain D.

- Less than 50% attendance: Two grades drop. However, a D grade will remain D.

Note:

1. *This Relaxation in attendance includes participation in all kinds of activities, medical emergencies, participation in placement opportunities, late registrations, disciplinary actions, or any other reasons not mentioned here.*
2. *Students will be responsible for maintaining attendance in the classes and monitoring their attendance online.*